

amplifier is built to handle weak audio signals—anything too strong causes it to overload and leads to distorted sound. So when you connect a music player to your sound card, start at a lower volume and increase it till the sound is just audible. After that, use the recording software to increase the volume of the sound input. This way, your sound will have little or no distortion.

If you have a file that you didn't record, but would like to tone down the volume, use the Normalize function which any sound editor will have. It reduces the volume levels in such a way that the loudest part of the sound file will be just loud enough not to cause any awful distortions.

### **Just plain distorted**

For a smooth, error-free recording, you need to maximise the memory available to your recording application. Close all unnecessary programs and try to perform as little activity as possible while sound is recording. You might also want to turn off System Restore on all drives while the recording is going on to improve performance.

### **Out of Space?**

All recording is first done in the uncompressed Wave format (.wav), and this can really hog disk space. Most recording software let you specify a location to store temporary recorded files. Select a partition with maximum free space to avoid any hassles in this department.

### **Rrrrrrip!**

Tearing your hair out trying to rip audio from CDs and DVDs? Every so often, you will find that your ripped tracks skip and click during playback. Check if the CD has any dust or scratches. A badly scratched CD won't rip properly, and you will need to look elsewhere for that music. If the CD is just dirty, use a soft, non-abrasive cloth to clean it.

Secondly, try not to load your PC too much while ripping audio. It needs a lot of memory to do its job, so make sure it gets it.